Module 10 Setup, Part 1: Your Project Repository

CIS-3901 Data Visualization and Presentation · Fall 2026 · Live in class, Thursday, Oct 22 (about 30 minutes) · Not graded

Purpose

Your Fairness Data and Sports Data projects end as a published website: a Quarto report and Quarto slides at your own web address. Today you make your own copy of the course project template on GitHub, switch on its website, and open it in Posit Cloud, where you'll work. You already saw the finished example in Module 9: acintron-cc.github.io/cis-3901-202710.

Where each project's work goes

Tidy Data: stays in the `challenge-tidy-data` project in Posit Cloud. Nothing changes there.

Fairness Data and Sports Data: go in the repository you create today, after you receive your verified tidy file.

Words for today

Word	Meaning
Repository (repo)	A project folder that Git tracks, with its full history of changes. GitHub stores repositories online.
Template	A repository made for copying. Your copy starts with the template's files, then it's yours alone: later changes to the template don't reach it.
Clone	Make a working copy of a repository somewhere else. Today, Posit Cloud clones your repository.
GitHub Pages	GitHub's free website hosting. It serves the `docs/` folder of your repository at your own address.

Task

You need: your GitHub username and password, your Posit Cloud login, and a laptop. Follow along as I demonstrate each step, then do it yourself.

Step 1. Copy the template (GitHub, about 8 minutes)

1. Sign in to github.com.
2. Open the template: https://github.com/acintron-cc/cis-3901-202710 (also linked in Blackboard).
3. Click the green **Use this template** button, then **Create a new repository**.
4. Fill in the form:
    a. **Owner:** your username.
    b. **Repository name:** `cis-3901-projects`
    c. **Public** (GitHub Pages needs a public repository on a free account).

   d. **Include all branches:** leave unchecked.
5. Click **Create repository**.

> **Check**
> The address bar shows `github.com/YOUR-USERNAME/cis-3901-projects`, and the repository name is labeled **Public**.

Step 2. Turn on your website (GitHub, about 5 minutes)

1. In **your** repository (not the template), click **Settings** (top row of tabs).
2. In the left sidebar, click **Pages**.
3. Under **Build and deployment**, set **Source** to **Deploy from a branch**.
4. Set **Branch** to `main` and the folder to `/docs`. Click **Save**.
5. Don't wait. The site takes 1 to 3 minutes to build; go on to Step 3.

Your site's address: `https://YOUR-USERNAME.github.io/cis-3901-projects/` (your username in lowercase).

Step 3. Open it in Posit Cloud (about 10 minutes)

1. On GitHub, in your repository, click the green **Code** button, choose the **HTTPS** tab, and click the copy icon. The address looks like `https://github.com/YOUR-USERNAME/cis-3901-projects.git`.
2. Go to posit.cloud and sign in.
3. In the left sidebar, choose the course space **CIS-3901-Fall2026** (not Your Workspace).
4. Click **New Project**, then **New Project from Git Repository**.
5. Paste the address you copied, then click **OK**. The project takes about a minute to open.

> **Careful**
> Paste the address of **your** repository: the one with your username in it, not `acintron-cc`. A project made from the template opens fine, but you won't be able to send your work back to GitHub.

Criteria: you're done when

- ☐ GitHub shows your repository `cis-3901-projects` under **your** username, marked **Public**.
- ☐ Settings › Pages says your site is live, and your site's address opens the course site (with the penguin example).
- ☐ Your Posit Cloud project in **CIS-3901-Fall2026** shows `_quarto.yml`, `data`, `docs`, `reports` and the other folders in the Files pane, and a **Git** tab appears in the top-right pane.
- ☐ You wrote down both links:

  Repository: https://github.com/ _____ /cis-3901-projects

  Site: https:// _____ .github.io/cis-3901-projects/

Post both links in Blackboard where your instructor asks for them.

If something goes wrong

What you see	What to do
No **Use this template** button	Sign in to GitHub first. Then reload the template page.
The repository is **Private**	Settings › General › Danger Zone › **Change repository visibility** › Public.
No **Settings** tab, or Settings changes the template	You're on the template, not your copy. Check that the address bar shows your username.
Pages: "404 There isn't a GitHub Pages site here"	Wait 2 minutes and reload. Check Settings › Pages: branch `main`, folder `/docs`. The address must use your username and `cis-3901-projects` exactly.
Posit Cloud: "Cannot access git repository"	Copy the address again from the **Code** button (no spaces at the ends). The repository must be Public.
The project is in **Your Workspace**	In the project list, open the project's menu (⋯) › **Move** › CIS-3901-Fall2026.
You used the template's address	Move that project to the trash and repeat Step 3 with your own address.

Next: Part 2 (self-paced)

The Part 2 tutorial, at https://acintron-cc.github.io/cis-3901-202710-guides › Module 10 (also linked in Blackboard), connects Posit Cloud to GitHub so your work can flow back: tell Git who you are, create a token, make your first commit and push, and publish your own site. About 45 minutes; finish it before the Fairness Data project starts.